

JEONGSOO SUH

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EDUCATION

Duke University
Ph.D. in Economics

2021 - 2026 (*expected*)

London School of Economics
M.Sc. in Economics (*with Distinction*)

2019 - 2021

Korea University
B.A. in Economics & B.S. in Financial Engineering (*with Great Honor*)

2013 - 2019

RESEARCH FIELDS

Labor Economics, Health Economics, Public Economics

JOB MARKET PAPER

“Child Protection in Response to Public Health Crises: Evidence from the Opioid Epidemic (solo-authored)”

Abstract: This paper examines the impacts of the opioid epidemic on child maltreatment and how Child Protective Services (CPS) responded to the epidemic. I use the reformulation of OxyContin, a nationwide supply shock in prescription opioids that exacerbated the opioid epidemic, as a natural experiment. Leveraging variation in states’ and counties’ exposure to this intervention, I find that the opioid epidemic led to an increase in maltreatment allegations, suggesting a rise in the underlying maltreatment risk. Despite heightened risk, institutional responses did not scale protective actions accordingly, resulting in more cases where children were left at home but subsequently reinvestigated for maltreatment. Foster care placement rates remained unchanged and administrative expenditures per allegation declined, pointing to a limited systemic response. This study underscores the inter-generational consequences of the opioid epidemic and highlights how public health crises can weaken protective systems, particularly when institutions lack the flexibility or capacity to adapt.

Presented at: Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Fall Conference, Canadian Economics Association (CEA) Annual Meeting, Western Economic Association International (WEAI) 100th Conference, Economics Graduate Student Conference, Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting, Korea-America Economic Association (KAEA) Job Market Conference, Duke University Labor/Public Seminar

WORKING PAPER

“Mechanism Reform for Task Allocation” (with E. Jason Baron, Richard Lombardo, Joseph Ryan, and Quitze Valenzuela-Stookey), *NBER Working Paper #32369*

Abstract: Reforming an existing system for allocating tasks among agents introduces additional political and institutional constraints relative to designing one in isolation. We develop a general mechanism-design framework for using data on agents’ performance to improve outcomes while ensuring that no agents are made worse off relative to the status quo. As an illustration, we apply our results to the assignment of Child Protective Services investigators to maltreatment cases. Simulations show the mechanism reduces false positives (unnecessary foster care placements) by up to 14% while also lowering false negatives (missed maltreatment cases) and overall placements.

WORK IN PROGRESS

“Effects of Controlling Prescription Opioids on Child Welfare”

Abstract: This paper examines the effects of Prescription Drug Monitoring Programs (PDMPs) on child maltreatment, distinguishing between two types that vary in policy intensity: modern and mandatory PDMPs. Leveraging the staggered rollout of PDMPs across states, I find that mandatory PDMPs, which require prescribers to consult the database, led to an 18 percent increase in maltreatment allegations. In contrast, modern PDMPs, which are fully electronic and integrated into clinical workflows but do not mandate prescriber use, did not yield statistically significant changes in allegations. These findings suggest that the unintended consequences of prescription opioid control policies can extend to child welfare, operating through their effects on parental behavior.

AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Program for Advanced Research in the Social Sciences Fellowship	<i>2025 - 2026</i>
Interdisciplinary fellowship awarded to one economics PhD student per year, Duke University	
Merit-based Bonus for Head Teaching Assistant	<i>Spring 2023</i>
\$2000 bonus awarded to outstanding head teaching assistants, Duke University	
Graduate School Summer Research Fellowship	<i>2022 - 2023</i>
Duke University	
Economics Department Graduate Fellowship	<i>2021 - 2022</i>
Duke University	
Great Honor	<i>2019</i>
Equivalent to Summa Cum Laude, Korea Univeristy	
Semester High Honors	<i>2013 - 2014, 2016 - 2018</i>
Awarded based on Semester GPA, Korea University	
Merit-based Honors Scholarships	<i>2013 - 2014</i>
Awarded based on Semester GPA, Korea University	

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

Certificate in College Teaching	<i>2026 (expected)</i>
Formal, documented training in college teaching, with official transcript record, Duke University	
Instructor	<i>Summer 2024</i>
Econometrics and Data Science (Undergraduate), Duke University	
Head Teaching Assistant	<i>Fall 2022, Spring 2023</i>
Statistical Foundations of Econometrics and Data Science (Undergraduate), Duke University	
Department-Sponsored Tutor	<i>Fall 2022</i>
Tutored Economics Ph.D. student in the first-year core Econometrics course, Duke University	

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2025: Canadian Economics Association (CEA) Annual Meeting, Western Economic Association International (WEAI) 100th Conference, Economics Graduate Student Conference, Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting, Korea-America Economic Association (KAEA) Job Market Conference, Duke University Labor/Public Seminar

2024: Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Fall Conference, Duke University Labor/Public Seminar

2023: Duke University Labor/Public Seminar

SERVICE

Co-Organizer, Labor/Public Economics Seminar, Duke University *Fall 2024, Spring 2025*

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Military Service *October 2014 - July 2016*
Served as a Korean Augmentation To the United States Army (KATUSA)

SKILLS

Computer Skills	Stata, R, Python, Matlab, L ^A T _E X
Languages	Korean (Native), English (Fluent)